

YUJIA CHEN

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (Spain)

Department of Business Administration

Website: yujiachen22.github.io / Email: yuchen@emp.uc3m.es / Telephone: +34 653 728 042

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EDUCATION

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain

Ph.D. in Management (Advisor: Kurt Desender)

2023 - 2027 (Expected)

MRes. in Business and Finance

2021 - 2023

Università Bocconi, Italy

Research Visit

Spring 2026

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, China

B.A. of Economics (Major in Finance, Minor in Management)

2016 - 2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Governance, Institutional Dynamics, Ownership, Gender Diversity

RESEARCH PAPERS

Working papers:

- **Compliance without Consensus: Global Investors, Board Gender Diversity, and External Scrutiny** (with K. Desender)

Job Market Paper.

Best Paper Award (Paper Development Workshop), 11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS) (2025)

Abstract: We examine how global institutional investors interact with domestic norms in shaping the consequences of governance reform. Using Japan's "Womenomics" reforms as a policy change that increases the visibility of gender diversity, we show that firms with higher Big Three institutional ownership experience larger increases in board gender diversity following the reform, primarily through director replacement rather than board expansion. We further find that firms more exposed to increases in board gender diversity experience higher levels of externally reported governance-related incidents, especially in male-dominated industries and among more visible firms. These increases are not accompanied by systematic declines in firm performance or governance quality indicators. Convergence in governance practices therefore does not necessarily imply convergence in how such changes are interpreted across institutional environments.

Presented at: 11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (2025), Università Bocconi PhD Seminar (2026)

- **Catalysts of Governance Convergence: The Influence of Foreign Ownership on the Change of Corporate Governance System** (with K. Desender)

Nominated for Best Paper Award, 11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS) (2025)

Abstract: How firms undertake system-level corporate governance change under cross-border pressure remains poorly understood. We examine when such pressure leads to governance architecture

reconfiguration, focusing on Japanese firms' adoption of the "audit committee" system. Drawing on the willing-and-able framework, we argue that responses depend on whether decision makers perceive a governance architecture as both salient and feasible within existing stakeholder-oriented structures. Using panel data on Japanese listed firms (2015–2023), we find that Anglo-American foreign ownership, particularly by active investors, increases adoption likelihood. These effects are stronger in weaker disclosure environments and weaker where stakeholder ties are more embedded. Adoption is associated with substantive board restructuring rather than symbolic compliance. Overall, governance reform proceeds through bounded, context-dependent reconfiguration rather than convergence.

Presented at: 9th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (2023), XXVII Workshop on Accounting and Management Control "Memorial Raymond Konopka" (2025), Strategy Science Doctoral Workshop at IESE (2025), 85th Academy of Management Annual Meeting (2025), 11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (2025), I Paper Development Workshop in Strategy of ACEDE (2025)

- **Ownership-Linked Reputational Spillovers: Firm Responses to Public Recognition and Scrutiny under Common Ownership** (with K. Desender)

Abstract: How do reputational signals experienced by one firm influence the behavior of other firms connected through common ownership? Prior research has primarily examined how common owners shape firm behavior through direct mechanisms such as stewardship, engagement, and monitoring. We argue that common ownership also generates ownership-linked reputational spillovers, whereby reputational gains and losses experienced by one portfolio firm influence the behavior of ownership-linked peers. We examine this argument in the context of gender diversity in Japan. Using selection into the Nadeshiko Brand as a positive reputational signal and publicly reported gender-inequality incidents as a negative reputational signal, we analyze how firms respond to reputational events experienced by peer firms connected through common ownership. Using data on Japanese listed firms from 2009 to 2023 and a staggered difference-in-differences design, we find that firms become more likely to publicly apply for the Nadeshiko Brand and increase female board representation following Nadeshiko recognition among ownership-linked peers. In contrast, firms become less likely to pursue public recognition following gender-inequality incidents experienced by ownership-linked peers while simultaneously increasing female board representation. Our findings identify ownership-linked reputational spillovers as an indirect channel through which common ownership shapes firm behavior and reveal that firms distinguish between public visibility and substantive governance adaptation when responding to positive and negative reputational signals.

Work in Progress:

- **Title of the paper** (with K. Desender)
Status: Data collection and preliminary analysis

CONFERENCES AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Università Bocconi PhD Seminar	May 2026
11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS)	Oct 2025
I Paper Development Workshop in Strategy of ACEDE	Oct 2025
85th Academy of Management Annual Meeting (AOM)	Jul 2025
Strategy Science Doctoral Workshop	Jun 2025
XXVII Workshop on Accounting and Management Control "Memorial Raymond Konopka"	Jan 2025
9th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS)	Oct 2023

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Best Paper Award (Paper Development Workshop) <i>11th Annual Conference of International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS)</i>	Oct 2025
FPI Grant for PhD Studies (PRE2022-104715) <i>Agencia Estatal de Investigación, Spanish Government</i>	2023 - 2027
MRes Stipend <i>Universidad Carlos III de Madrid</i>	2021 - 2023

ACADEMIC TRAINING

Digital Markets and the Economics of Data <i>IESE Business School and Fundación Ramón Areces</i>	Jun 2025
LLMs and Machine Learning for Unstructured Data <i>IESE Business School and Fundación Ramón Areces</i>	Jun 2024
Academic Writing in English <i>Universidad Carlos III de Madrid</i>	Spring 2024
Speak More Clearly in English <i>Universidad Carlos III de Madrid</i>	Spring 2024
Empirical Analysis of Firm Performance <i>CEMFI Summer School</i>	Sep 2022
Research Assistant (Full-Time) <i>Survey and Research Center for China Household Finance</i>	2020 - 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid:

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|---|---------------------|
| - 13162 Management Accounting (Undergrad, Theory and Practice Sessions) | Fall 2024 - Present |
| - 13634 Introduction to Business Administration (Undergrad, Practice Session) | Fall 2023 |

OTHER INFORMATION

Programming Skills: Python, Stata
Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)
Citizenship: Chinese

REFERENCES

Kurt Desender Associate Professor of Management Department of Business Administration Universidad Carlos III de Madrid kdesende@emp.uc3m.es	Second Referee Name Title Department University email@example.com
Third Referee Name Title Department University email@example.com	